

A collection of playing cards. At the top left is a 10 of Hearts. Next to it is a King of Clubs. To the right of the King of Clubs is an 8 of Diamonds. Further right is a Queen of Spades. At the bottom, a fan of cards is shown, starting with the Ace of Spades on the left and ending with the 6 of Spades on the right. The cards are arranged in a way that suggests a game or a hand being dealt.

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

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				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
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Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 3

♥ J 2

♦ Q J 10 7

♣ 8 5 4 2

♠ 6

♥ A K Q 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ A Q J 10 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7 4 2

♥ 9 7 3

♦ A K 5 2

♣ 9 6

♠ A Q 9 8 5

♥ 10 8 6 5

♦ 8 4

♣ K 7

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

With his Reverse, partner has shown at least 17 points and at least 4 ♥s.

You could fall back on the guidelines and say that with 10 points you need to make a positive bid at this time, but it is simpler to just rely on "SHE WHO KNOWS, GOES."

Since you know of an 8-card ♥ fit and at least 27 points you bid 4 ♥.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 7 5
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ A Q 5 3
 ♣ J 10 8 4

♠ A 3 2

♥ 10 9 4

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ A Q 9



♠ K Q J 6 4

♥ A K J 7 6

♦ K 6

♣ 5

♠ 9 8

♥ Q 5 3

♦ J 10 7

♣ K 7 6 3 2

*West**North**East**South*

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

It may be tempting to open 1 ♥, planning on Reversing in ♠ at your second turn to show your big hand.

Don't. A Reverse should always show an unbalanced hand with the first suit longer. So you open 1 ♠ and partner replies 2 ♠.

If you had opened 1 ♥ partner would have replied 1NT. Then when you Reversed with 2 ♠ he would have assumed you had a 4-card ♠ suit and would probably have put you back in ♥s, your known 5-card suit.

Things would have gotten confusing, to say the least.